

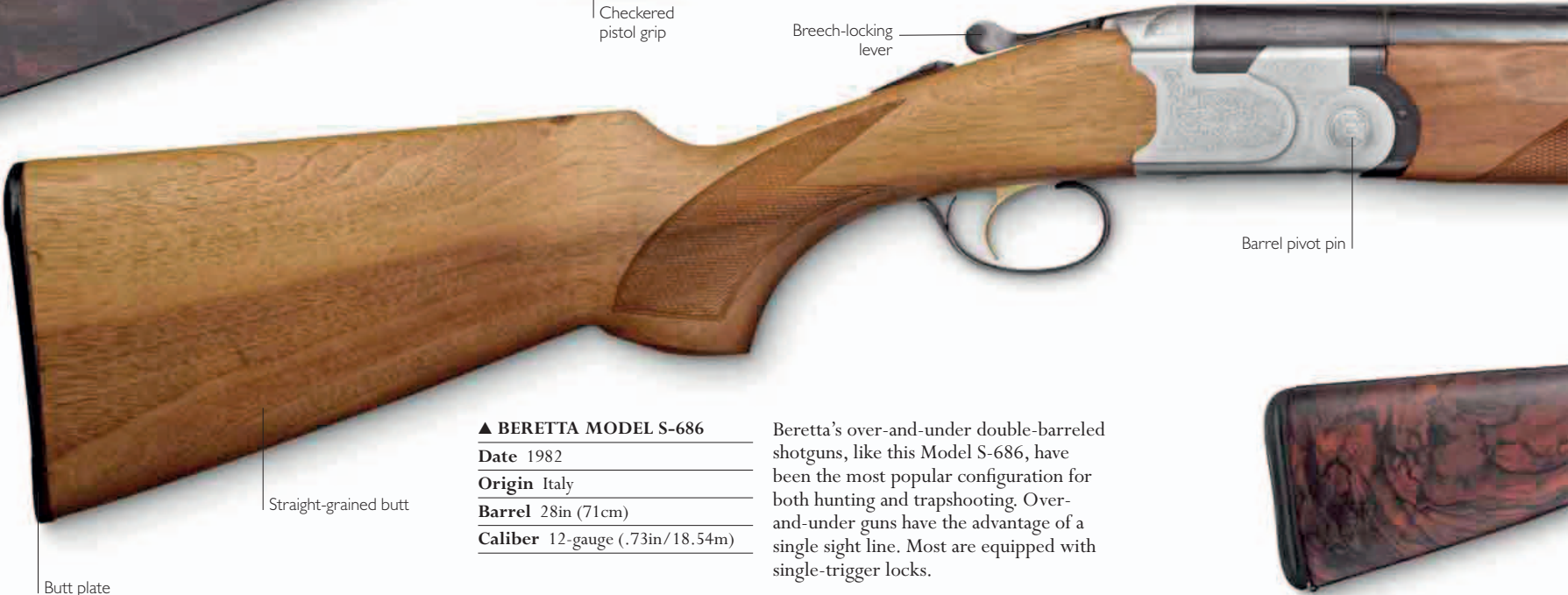
DOUBLE-BARRELED SHOTGUNS

Since the 18th century, double-barreled shotguns have been characterized by a pair of barrels placed horizontally next to each other. By aligning them carefully, the shot patterns created during firing can be made to converge at some specific point forward of the muzzle, such as 50 yards (46m). Recently, over-and-under guns (shotguns having their barrels set vertically one above the other) have gained popularity, especially among trapshooters and skeet shooters. The shot patterns of over-and-under guns can be made to converge as well, albeit vertically, thus allowing shooters used to rifles more opportunities of hitting a clay pigeon or a live bird.



▲ **DARNE ROTARY-BREECH SHOTGUN**
Date 1965
Origin France
Barrel 25½in (65cm)
Caliber 16-gauge (.66in/16.76mm)

Made by Darne, this side-by-side shotgun has a patented breech action. Freed by means of the lever on top of the butt behind the breech, the entire lock rotates through a quarter turn to expose the chambers. Returning it to battery (the state of the gun's action when it is ready to fire) cocks the gun. The lever on the side of the breechblock is a cross-bolt safety.



▲ **BERETTA MODEL S-686**
Date 1982
Origin Italy
Barrel 28in (71cm)
Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.54m)

Beretta's over-and-under double-barreled shotguns, like this Model S-686, have been the most popular configuration for both hunting and trapshooting. Over-and-under guns have the advantage of a single sight line. Most are equipped with single-trigger locks.